Dr. Cecilee ("Ceci") Hayes

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Education

M.F.A. (Master of Feline Arts), Institute for Advanced Mouse Hunting May 2017
B.S. (Bachelor of Sunbeams), School of Household Observation May 2008

Journal Articles

Hayes, C. (2026). The lap availability crisis. *Journal of Human-Feline Relations*, 15(2), 41-58.

Hayes, C. (2025). Beyond catnip: A comparative study of plush carrots and other enrichment Objects. *Journal of Feline Behavioral Research*, 12(3), 17-29.

Hayes, C. (2025). Keyboard intervention as a workplace wellness strategy. *Computers & Cats Quarterly*, 8(1), 22-37.

Hayes, C. (2024). Thinking inside the box: A Mixed-Methods investigation of cardboard preference among household cats. *Proceedings of the International Symposium on Feline Studies*.

Grants and Fellowships

Principal Investigator, Comparative Analysis of Plush Carrot Engagement Across Domestic Contexts, National Institute of Play Studies, 2025-2026. Award: 400 Treats.

Feline Research Fellowship, Center for Advanced Box Studies, 2024.

Research Projects

The Existential Meaning of Boxes: A long-term interdisciplinary examination of cardboard boxes as sites of comfort, identity formation, belonging, and contemplative retreat, as well as an investigation into the paradoxical observation that cats routinely select the smallest available container despite access to comfortable beds bought by their owners.